

FIELD LIBRARY / FULL FIELD GUIDE

Do-not-drink advisory

UTILITIES / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Use commercially bottled or officially approved water for drinking, cooking, brushing teeth, ice, formula and pets. Do not try to make chemically contaminated water safe by boiling. Read the notice for which other uses are allowed.

Do now.

**Read restrictions**

01

Check what contaminant is involved and which uses are prohibited.

**Replace drinking water**

02

Use the approved alternative for anything swallowed or used to prepare food.

**Check household uses**

03

Bathing, laundry and cleaning depend on the exact local notice.

**Wait for clearance**

04

Follow any flushing or filter replacement instructions before resuming use.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Set aside sealed water for drinking, food and medicines, including pet needs. Mark the unsafe taps so nobody uses them by habit. If you have no trusted update, keep using the safer supply; restored pressure or clear appearance does not establish safety.

Watch for.

Clear appearance and normal taste cannot confirm safety.

People & practical needs.

Prevent accidental drinking by children, visitors or people with memory difficulties. Label restricted taps and safe containers. Arrange an alternative for medicine, oral care, pets and any medical use rather than treating those as exceptions.

Keep essentials within reach.

Prioritize supplies named in this guide that are usable by the person who needs them. Keep the checklist and relevant contact details accessible. Check carrying capacity, storage and equipment instructions in advance; collecting equipment must not delay the immediate protective action.

Next decisions.

Save the utility notice and alternative-water distribution location offline.

Check the next usable option

Save the utility notice and alternative-water distribution location offline.

When the first option is unavailable

Set aside sealed water for drinking, food and medicines, including pet needs. Mark the unsafe taps so nobody uses them by habit. If you have no trusted update, keep using the safer supply; restored pressure or clear appearance does not establish safety.

Questions in the field.

Why not simply boil it?

Chemical contamination can remain after boiling and some substances can become more concentrated. Follow the restriction exactly and obtain a verified alternate drinking source. A home treatment claim must match the identified contaminant; an ordinary filter is not a universal solution.

Can I use it for other tasks?

Use only the purposes explicitly allowed by the notice. Do not infer that cooking, brushing teeth, making ice or medicine preparation is safe because bathing is mentioned. Check the exact instruction before each household use.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

Do-not-drink advisory · official guidance

<https://www.cdc.gov/water-emergency/about/drinking-water-advisories-an-overview.html>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/do-not-drink/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.